

WC26 — Actionable Advancement & Knockout Bets

Polymarket · 28 fixtures played · quarter-Kelly on \$1310 pool · ranked by expected profit · likely-to-pay (≥60%) + real edge (≥4%)

#	Bet	Market	P(pay)	Price	Edge	Odds	Stake	EV \$
1	YES Iran	Reach R32 (knockout)	62% ●○○	0.40	+21.2%	2.46	\$66	\$34.1
2	YES Colombia	Win Group K	65% ●○○	0.49	+14.8%	2.01	\$66	\$19.5
3	NO Portugal	Win Group K	70% ●○○	0.55	+14.0%	1.79	\$66	\$16.5
4	NO United States	Reach Quarterfinals	79% ●●○	0.65	+13.2%	1.52	\$66	\$13.2
5	NO Norway	Reach Quarterfinals	79% ●●○	0.66	+12.2%	1.50	\$66	\$12.0
6	NO Morocco	Win Group C	81% ●●○	0.70	+10.8%	1.42	\$66	\$10.0
7	NO France	Reach Final	80% ●●○	0.70	+9.3%	1.42	\$66	\$8.6
8	NO Czech Republic	Reach R32 (knockout)	79% ●●○	0.71	+7.1%	1.40	\$66	\$6.5
9	NO Japan	Reach Round of 16	67% ●○○	0.59	+6.9%	1.67	\$56	\$6.5
10	NO Senegal	Reach Round of 16	76% ●●○	0.69	+6.8%	1.44	\$66	\$6.4
11	YES Australia	Reach R32 (knockout)	95% ●●●	0.87	+7.8%	1.14	\$66	\$5.9
12	NO England	Reach Semifinals	69% ●○○	0.62	+5.9%	1.59	\$52	\$4.9
13	NO Ghana	Reach Round of 16	86% ●●●	0.80	+5.4%	1.24	\$66	\$4.4
14	YES Brazil	Win Group C	65% ●○○	0.59	+5.4%	1.67	\$44	\$4.0
15	NO Bosnia and Herzegovina	Reach Round of 16	86% ●●●	0.81	+4.7%	1.23	\$66	\$3.8
16	YES Scotland	Reach R32 (knockout)	86% ●●●	0.81	+4.5%	1.23	\$66	\$3.6
17	YES Croatia	Reach R32 (knockout)	82% ●●○	0.77	+4.0%	1.29	\$59	\$3.1
18	NO Germany	Reach Quarterfinals	66% ●○○	0.61	+4.2%	1.62	\$36	\$2.4
PORTFOLIO TOTAL (18 bets, 1 per team, fee-adjusted)							\$1098	\$165

How to read this: Each bet is the single best advancement/knockout market for that team (nested stages are correlated, so only one is shown). **P(pay)** = model probability the bet wins (●●● ≥85%, ●●○ ≥72%, ●○○ ≥60%). **Edge** is fee-adjusted (Polymarket 3%·p·(1-p) taker fee netted out). **Stake** = ¼-Kelly, capped at 5% (\$65.50). Backing a no-hoper like Qatar never appears — there's no edge there; the value is in **NO** bets fading overpriced favourites' deep runs and **YES** bets on underpriced qualifiers.

Method & caveats

Model

20,000-sim Elo + Dixon-Coles tournament, conditioned on all 28 played group fixtures. Per-team stage probabilities $P(R32 \rightarrow \text{Final})$ + group winner.

Market

Live Polymarket advancement markets: "advance to knockout", "reach Round of 16/QF/SF/Final", "Win Group X". YES & NO both priced; the side the model favours is shown.

Edge & sizing

$\text{fee_adj_edge} = \text{sim_prob} - \text{buy_price} - \text{taker_fee}$. Stake = $\frac{1}{4}$ -Kelly at effective odds $1/(\text{price} + \text{fee})$, capped 5% of the \$1310 PM pool (`src/wca/advancement.py`).

Filter rationale

Sorting by raw edge% surfaces 500:1 lottery longshots (Jordan, Algeria) the model rates near-zero — Kelly barely funds them and they almost never pay. This list requires **both** $\geq 60\%$ payout probability **and** $\geq 4\%$ edge: bets that are likely to win and still +EV.

Settlement

Advancement/knockout markets settle on full result incl. extra-time/penalties — kept on a separate track, never mixed with 90-minute legs.

Correlation note

"NO Portugal win Group K" and "YES Colombia win Group K" express the same view ($\text{Colombia} \geq \text{Portugal}$ in K). Treat as one thesis when sizing combined exposure.

Liquidity

Verify book depth before sizing; thin advancement books may not fill the full Kelly stake at the quoted price.